ARCHITECTURE STRATEGY BRIEFING

Engineered from the mission down

How Stratos, MACH1, and Mission Control deliver mission outcomes as one strategy

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THE STARTING POINT

Three problems stand between users and the mission

A sprawling portfolio

Overlapping applications and duplicated services, many on aging, end-of-life stacks.

A fragmented experience

Every tool looks and works differently, and help is hard to find.

SI bolted on, not built in

It arrives tool by tool, with no shared orchestration or consistent governance.

Each one costs the mission time and trust, and none can be fixed one application at a time.

WHERE WE SIT

Direct support to the mission

GENERAL SUPPORT

Enterprise architecture

Priorities set by

Enterprise leadership, for the whole agency

Built for

Scale, uniform standards, and shared infrastructure

For example

Mandated identity and access, and other agency-wide services

standards and foundational services we inherit



DIRECT SUPPORT

Our mission portfolio

Priorities set by

The mission we serve, through the triad

Built for

Mission tempo, closeness to users, and mission-specific capability

For example

SuperApps, capability platforms, and SI orchestration

Decentralized execution, centralized standards. We build on the enterprise's standards and foundational services, and extend them for the mission. Where we duplicate one, it is a deliberate choice for mission tempo.

THE METHOD

What mission engineering is

The deliberate planning, analysis, and integration of operational and system capabilities to reach required mission outcomes.

Top down, the mission is broken into tasks, then capabilities, then systems.

Bottom up, instrumentation reports along the mission thread, the end-to-end sequence of tasks that gets the mission done.

WHY IT MATTERS

Traceability

Every service rolls up to a capability, a task, and an objective, so losing one shows exactly what falls.

One shared language

Mission owners, tradecraft experts, designers, and engineers judge the same mission, each at their own level.

Honest thresholds

Baselines come first; mission analysis then defines what “required” means.

FOUR LEVELS, FOUR MEASURES

Every system is judged by its effect on the mission

OPERATIONAL	**Measure of Success**	Did we achieve the mission's objectives?
FUNCTIONAL	**Measure of Effectiveness**	Can people accomplish the tasks it requires?
CAPABILITY	**Measure of Capability**	Are our capabilities sufficient for those tasks?
PHYSICAL	**Measure of Performance**	Do the systems perform as specified?

Each level exists to serve the one above it.

THE PAYOFF

How it leads to better outcomes

Prioritize by mission impact

Work is ranked by the measure it moves, not by who asks loudest.

Design from mission tasks

Workflows come from the triad's breakdown of the mission, not product intuition.

Invest where capability falls short

Funding goes to the platforms that cannot yet carry their tasks.

Catch and restore fast

Release markers tie a falling measure straight to its cause.

ONE EXAMPLE, TRACED END TO END

Delivery
A release ships

→

Performance
Errors jump on one endpoint

→

Capability
A platform drops below required

→

Effectiveness
Analysts abandon a task

→

Success
An objective is at risk, and we know why

THE STRATEGY

Three lines of effort, one mission

TOP DOWN

Stratos

Shapes how people experience, learn, and get help with their tools.

BOTTOM UP

MACH1

Builds the platforms and shared services everything else runs on.

ACROSS

Mission Control

Changes how the office plans, delivers, and steers its work.

Above all three: a triad of tradecraft experts, the HCD and UX team, and Requirements Management defines the mission need each line serves.

LINE OF EFFORT 1 · EXPERIENCE

Stratos

Make every mission task easy to learn, easy to get help with, and easy to finish.

Answers to: Measure of Effectiveness, through task success on mission workflows

Engage
the Workforce

People feel confident and capable in the tools they rely on.

Empower
the Users

Help arrives in the moment someone needs it.

Evolve
the Capabilities

Applications follow how the mission's work actually gets done.

Enable
the Developers

Teams build consistent interfaces from one design system.

LINE OF EFFORT 2 · ARCHITECTURE

MACH1

Give the office one secure, resilient foundation that every capability can build on.

Answers to: Measures of Capability and Performance, through service-level attainment

Strengthen the Foundation

Hardened, current, and built to survive failure.

Standardize the Platforms

Each capability runs as a product on one self-hosted stack.

Streamline the Portfolio

One shared service per need, retiring the duplicates.

Scale the Intelligence

Governed superintelligence (SI) available to every application.

LINE OF EFFORT 3 · WAYS OF WORKING

Mission Control

Run the converged office as one team that delivers in small steps.

Answers to: delivery performance, which sits alongside the four levels

Align the Work

Every team works the mission's top priority from one backlog.

Accelerate the Flow

Value reaches users sooner and more often.

Amplify the Teams

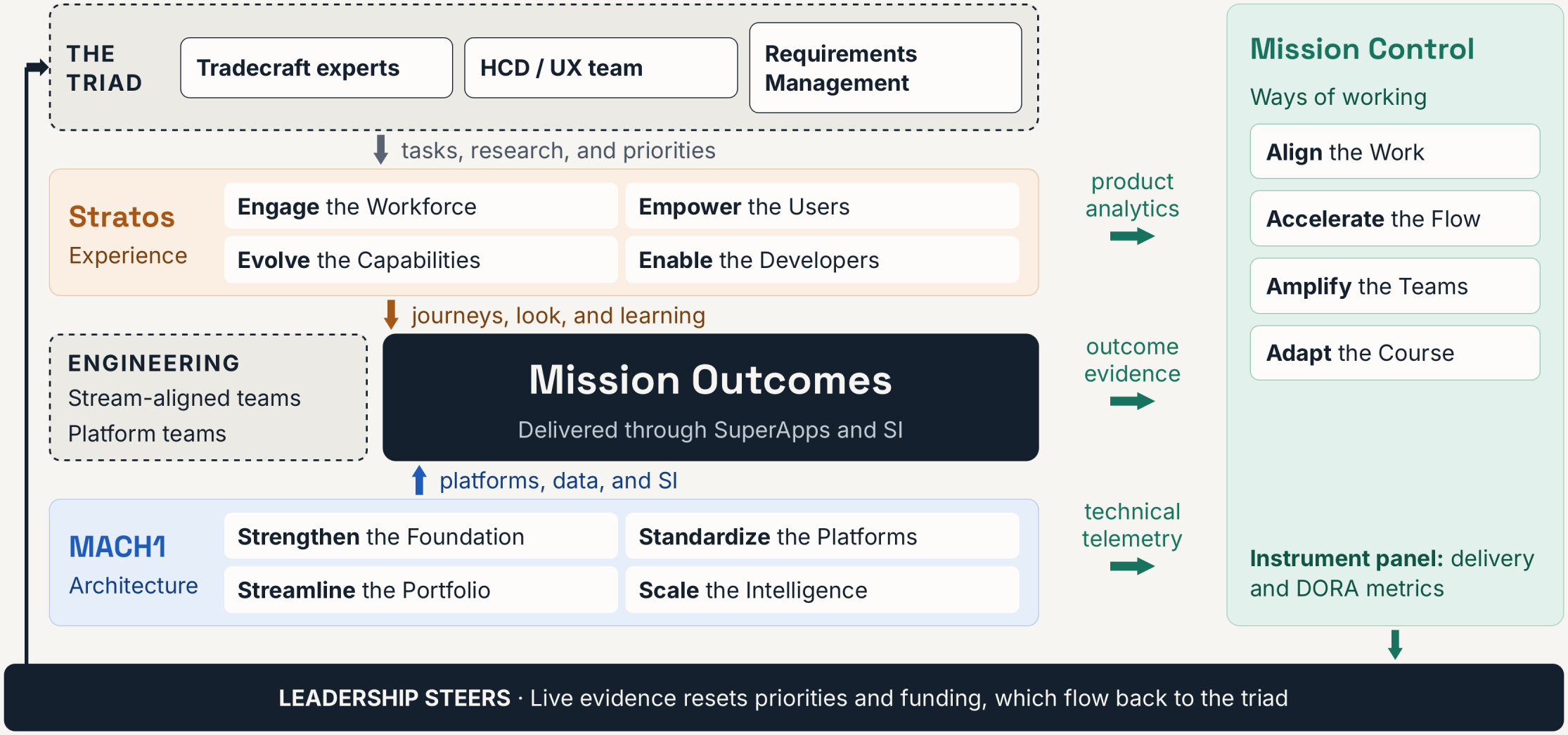
Long-lived teams own outcomes, not assigned tasks.

Adapt the Course

Leadership steers on live data instead of status slides.

THE INTEGRATED VIEW

One mission system



METRICS THAT MATTER

Instrumentation beneath every level

Measure of Success	**Mission owner assessment** Informed by all three layers; never generated by telemetry	**Mission owners**
Measure of Effectiveness	**Layer 1, product analytics** Task success, time to complete, friction, support contact	**Stratos**
Measure of Capability	**Layer 2, rolled up per capability platform** Service-level attainment and workflow health	**MACH1**
Measure of Performance	**Layer 2, technical telemetry** Availability, server errors, p95 and p99 latency, saturation	**MACH1**
Delivery, alongside	**Layer 3, programmatic delivery** The four DORA metrics, flow, and the work ratio	**Mission Control**

MEASURING SUCCESS

Every signal is tied to a decision

When this happens	This decision is forced	Decided by
A service exhausts its error budget	Feature releases pause for reliability work	Service owner with SRE
Users report incidents before monitoring does	Observability gap review; new monitors committed	Platform engineering with the service owner
New-capability work stays below baseline for two quarters	Debt investment review and rebalanced capacity	Engineering leadership with product

Health indicators, not scorecards

No metric ranks a person or a team.

Segment before aggregating

Signals are cut by service, endpoint, and cohort before any rollup.

Integrity watched from day one

A silent data stream is treated as broken, not as good news.

GUARDRAILS

Red lines we will not cross

STRATOS

No user left stranded

A tool retires only when its replacement carries the full mission workflow.

The human stays in command

SI never hides its reasoning or removes a person's ability to override it.

MACH1

No lock-in

Nothing that binds the office to one hyperscaler or a vendor we cannot leave.

Security is never traded for speed

Access controls and accreditation hold, whatever the deadline.

MISSION CONTROL

No side-door priorities

All work enters through Requirements Management and a single backlog.

Evidence over opinion

No portfolio decision without live data behind it.

ROADMAP

From foundation to first deployments

	Through December 2026	January 2027	Metrics that Matter phases 1 to 3
Stratos	Triad defines the core mission workflows	First SuperApps ship with help and training ready on day one	Baselines first, then required task-success thresholds
MACH1	Whole portfolio on Nitro and Platforma, with no end-of-life dependencies	Capability platforms carry the first user-facing releases	Per-capability rollups, then error-budget triggers
Mission Control	One backlog in place; team structure decided	First releases on the new cadence, with DORA computing live	Flow metrics live; manual status reporting retired

THE ASK

Four decisions we need from leadership

1. Endorse the strategy, its three lines of effort, and their red lines.
2. Approve the Team Topologies structure by December 2026.
3. Name the mission owners who will assess the Measure of Success.
4. Set the quarter when Metrics that Matter Phase 1 begins.

Built for the mission.
Measured by the mission.

Stratos MACH1 Mission Control